The joint code–hull distribution of repeated-root constacyclic codes over finite products of finite fields via transfer matrices

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Abstract

We study λ-constacyclic codes of length $n = Pn_0$, with P a power of the characteristic p and $\gcd(n_0, p) = 1$, over a finite product $A \cong \prod_s K_s$ of finite fields, for twists compatible with the k-Galois pairing. Such codes are parametrized by exponent vectors on the irreducible factors of $x^{n_0} - \mu_s$. We show that the Galois dual and hull are governed by the reciprocal involution on those factors, and that the hull dimension is a sum of nearest-neighbour edge terms $\min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$ along its orbits. This gives a transfer-matrix formula for the joint distribution of the code dimension and the hull dimension over all labeled exponent assignments; the total number of codes; the number of LCD codes, $2^{\#\text{orbits}}$, independent of P; counts of self-orthogonal and dual-containing codes; and the exact mean and variance of the hull dimension, with orbits of length one treated separately. Worked examples are verified by explicit construction of codes.

Keywords: constacyclic codes; repeated-root codes; Galois hull; joint enumerator; transfer matrix; finite products of finite fields.
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1 Introduction

Algebraic coding theory studies linear codes whose algebraic structure makes their generators, duals, and parameters accessible. A λ-constacyclic code is invariant under the λ-twisted cyclic shift and, through the coefficient identification, is an ideal of $K[x]/(x^n - \lambda)$ [13, 18]. When $\gcd(n, p) = 1$, the polynomial $x^n - \lambda$ is separable; in the repeated-root regime considered here, p divides n and the irreducible factors occur with multiplicity. For a code C with Euclidean dual $C^\perp$, the hull $C \cap C^\perp$ records the overlap between a code and its dual: it is zero for an LCD code, equals C for a self-orthogonal code, and equals the dual for a dual-containing code. Replacing the Euclidean pairing by the Galois pairing of Fan and Zhang [12] gives the k-Galois hull $\mathrm{Hull}_k(C) = C \cap D(C)$, where $D(C)$ is the dual with respect to a Frobenius-twisted pairing. This paper studies how the two dimensions $\dim C$ and $\dim \mathrm{Hull}_k(C)$ vary together over a whole family of repeated-root constacyclic codes.

Much of the existing work determines the hull of a specified code or an average over a family. Debnath, Prakash and Islam [8] determined the Galois hull dimension of a given constacyclic code over a finite field, including repeated-root lengths $n = n'p^\nu$; under the additional restriction $e \mid 4(e - k)$ and $e \nmid 2(e - k)$ on the field degree, they also counted such codes according to hull dimension alone, in the cases where the reciprocal-orbit lengths are 1, 2 and 4 (the correction [9] makes only minor textual changes). Debnath and Prakash [4] subsequently computed average Galois hull dimensions over finite fields and over an auxiliary ring, while Debnath, Islam, Yadav and Prakash [7] studied constacyclic codes with small Galois hull dimension. Thus both the per-code hull dimension in the single-field case and its average are established results, and they are not claimed as new here.

Related per-code theories have been developed in neighbouring settings. Debnath, Islam, Martínez-Moro and Prakash [6] work over affine algebra rings, decomposing the alphabet into component codes over $\mathbb{F}_q$; they obtain the hull generator and dimension of a given code componentwise, together with an LCD criterion, and leave the enumeration of codes over the affine algebra by hull dimension open. Eldin and Solé [11] construct generator polynomial matrices for the Galois dual and hull of a given multi-twisted code over a single finite field—constacyclic codes being the index-one case—and derive a hull-dimension formula and self-orthogonal and LCD criteria from them. Relative hulls for general linear codes, including e-Galois hulls, were studied in [1], and mass formulas, monotonicity results, and constructions for linear codes with prescribed hull dimensions were given in [15, 16, 2, 17]. Galois hulls have also been studied for cyclic serial codes over a finite chain ring [21] and for separable double cyclic codes over $\mathbb{Z}_{p^2}$ [5]; cyclic and negacyclic codes with one-dimensional hulls were characterized in [10]; and repeated-root constacyclic codes and their Euclidean duals in special lengths have a substantial literature [3, 20, 22, 23].

The closest work nevertheless leaves open the distributional question addressed here. A per-code formula, an average, or a count by hull dimension alone does not determine how the pairs $(\dim C, \dim \mathrm{Hull}_k(C))$ are distributed over all codes in the family. Our objective is to determine this joint distribution for repeated-root constacyclic codes of length $n = Pn_0$, with P a power of p and $\gcd(n_0, p) = 1$, over a finite product $A \cong \prod_s K_s$ of finite fields, for twists compatible with the k-Galois pairing. In this setting each component code is described by exponents $a_f \in \{0, \dots, P\}$ attached to the distinct irreducible factors of a separable polynomial $x^{n_0} - \mu_s$; the aim is an enumerator in which every orbit of the reciprocal involution on these factors contributes independently to the count of labeled assignments with given code and hull dimensions.

The starting point is an exponent description of the Galois dual and hull over an arbitrary finite product of finite fields. For a single field component, the resulting hull-dimension formula agrees with [8, Theorem 3]; it is therefore a foundation for the counting below rather than a new per-code result, complementing the $\mathbb{F}_q$-component form in [6] and the per-code generator polynomial matrix machinery of [11]. Organizing the factors into orbits of the reciprocal involution makes both dimensions sums over orbit edges: the code dimension contributes $w_O \sum_i (P - \alpha_i)$ and the hull dimension contributes $w_O \sum_i \min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$ on an orbit of weight w_O. Closed walks in a $(P{+}1)$-state transfer matrix encode these edge contributions, and the product of the orbit traces is the bivariate enumerator $\mathcal{E}(u, z)$, whose coefficient of $u^K z^H$ counts the labeled assignments with $(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C, \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C)) = (K, H)$. From this enumerator we obtain the total number of assignments, the code-dimension distribution, the symmetry $K \leftrightarrow \Delta - K$, the number $2^{\#\mathrm{orbits}}$ of LCD assignments, and closed forms for the self-orthogonal and dual-containing families. Under the uniform distribution on labeled assignments, orbit independence then yields exact means and variances for the two dimensions and shows that they are uncorrelated. For a single field component the hull mean agrees with [4, Theorem 3.3], so it too is credited rather than claimed; the contribution of this paper, relative to the closest literature above, is the joint code–hull enumerator over a product of finite fields, the labeled counts drawn from it, and the second-order moment formulas.

The paper is organized as follows. Section 2 fixes the conventions, in particular the code-first Galois pairing on which the dual formulas depend. Sections 3–5 develop the parametrization, the Galois dual, and the hull formula in exponent form. Section 6 proves the transfer-matrix enumerator and its specialization at $P = 1$. Sections 7 and 8 contain the counting corollaries and the moment formulas. Section 9 gives worked examples and describes the computational verification, and Section 10 records the scope and limitations. Throughout, counts are over labeled exponent assignments, not over equivalence or isometry classes of codes.

2 Preliminaries and conventions

Let p be a prime, $q = p^e$, and let $0 \le k < e$ be a fixed Galois index. Let

$$A \;\cong\; \prod_{s=1}^{N} K_s, \qquad K_s = \mathbb{F}_{q^{m_s}} = \mathbb{F}_{p^{d_s}}, \quad d_s = em_s,$$

with fixed component labels. (Standard terminology for constacyclic codes follows [13, 18].)

Terminology. We call A an *affine algebra*: equivalently, A is a finite-dimensional commutative $\mathbb{F}_q$-algebra of the form $\mathbb{F}_q[X_1, \dots, X_\ell]/\langle t_1(X_1), \dots, t_\ell(X_\ell)\rangle$ in which each t_i is *square-free*, i.e. has no repeated irreducible factor; square-freeness is what makes A reduced (étale), hence a finite product of finite fields. Only this decomposition, the component Galois twists, and the weights $w_O = m_s \deg f$ enter the results below, so we state the setting throughout as a finite product of finite fields. A *labeled* assignment is an exponent tuple together with the fixed component and factor labels; all counts are over labeled assignments. On K_s write $\sigma(\alpha) = \alpha^{p^k}$ and $\rho(\alpha) = \alpha^{p^{d_s-k}} = \sigma^{-1}$.

Definition 2.1 (code-first Galois pairing)**.** For one component (the subscript s suppressed), the k-Galois pairing on K^n is $\langle x, y\rangle_k = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} x_i\, \sigma(y_i)$, the *code-first* dual of a code $C \subseteq K^n$ is $D(C) = \{y \in K^n : \langle c, y\rangle_k = 0 \text{ for all } c \in C\}$, and the k-Galois hull is $\mathrm{Hull}_k(C) = C \cap D(C)$. The Euclidean dual is denoted $C^\perp$.

This is the k-Galois inner product introduced by Fan and Zhang [12]. The code-first slot order agrees with the Galois dual convention of Liu and Pan [14]; in the finite-field case the dictionary is $D(C) = \sigma^{e-k}(C^\perp)$. The slot order is part of the definition: the candidate y occupies the σ-twisted slot, and this is what makes $D(C) = \rho(C^\perp)$ (coordinatewise ρ; Proposition 4.2) rather than the analogous statement with σ. All dual formulas below use this convention. The global pairing on A^n is the tuple of component pairings; a code over A is an A-submodule of A^n.

Fix a power P of p, and $n = Pn_0$ with $\gcd(n_0, p) = 1$. Let $\lambda = (\lambda_s) \in A^*$ and $M_s(x) = x^n - \lambda_s \in K_s[x]$. Since $a \mapsto a^P$ is a bijection of the finite field K_s, there is a unique $\mu_s \in K_s^*$ with $\mu_s^P = \lambda_s$. Writing $\bar{M}_s(x) = x^{n_0} - \mu_s$, we have $M_s = \bar{M}_s^{\,P}$ in characteristic p, and $\bar{M}_s$ is separable because $\bar{M}_s' = n_0 x^{n_0-1}$ and every root of $\bar{M}_s$ is nonzero. Let $\mathcal{F}_s$ be the set of distinct monic irreducible factors of $\bar{M}_s$ over K_s; then $M_s = \prod_{f\in\mathcal{F}_s} f^P$.

An *exponent assignment* on component s is a tuple $a = (a_f)_{f\in\mathcal{F}_s}$ with $a_f \in \{0, \dots, P\}$; put $g_a = \prod_f f^{a_f}$ and $C_s(a) = \langle g_a\rangle \subseteq K_s[x]/(M_s)$. A global assignment is a tuple of component assignments.

A *λ-constacyclic code* over A is an A-submodule of A^n closed under the componentwise λ-constacyclic shift $(c_0, \dots, c_{n-1}) \mapsto (\lambda c_{n-1}, c_0, \dots, c_{n-2})$. Under the coefficient identification $A^n \cong A[x]/(x^n - \lambda)$, this shift is multiplication by x; hence the λ-constacyclic codes over A are exactly the ideals of $A[x]/(x^n - \lambda)$, an equivalence that needs no separability or compatibility hypothesis. From now on, "code over A" means a λ-constacyclic code over A; componentwise these are tuples of λ_s-constacyclic codes (Proposition 6.2).

For a monic polynomial $f(x) = \sum_{i=0}^{r} c_i x^i$ with $f(0) = c_0 \neq 0$, define the (Frobenius-twisted) reciprocal

$$f^{\#}(x) \;=\; \rho(c_0)^{-1} \sum_{i=0}^{r} \rho(c_i)\, x^{\,r-i},$$

which is monic of degree r. Every $f \in \mathcal{F}_s$ satisfies $f(0) \neq 0$ since $\bar{M}_s(0) = -\mu_s \neq 0$.

Definition 2.2 (compatibility and the involution τ_s)**.** The twist λ_s is *compatible* if $\lambda_s^{1+p^{d_s-k}} = 1$. Since K_s^* is cyclic, the number of compatible twists in K_s^* is $\gcd\big(1 + p^{d_s-k},\, p^{d_s} - 1\big)$; in particular $\lambda_s = 1$ is always compatible, and $\lambda_s = -1$ is compatible when p is odd. Under

compatibility, $\tau_s : \mathcal{F}_s \to \mathcal{F}_s$, $\tau_s(f) = f^{\#}$, is a permutation (Theorem 3.2). We assume compatibility for every s from Section 4 on. A τ_s-orbit is written $O = (f_0, \dots, f_{L-1})$ with $\tau_s(f_i) = f_{i+1}$, indices modulo $L = L_O$; we set $\alpha_i = a_{f_i}$ and call α_{i-1} the predecessor of α_i. Since $\#$ preserves degrees, all factors in an orbit have the same degree; the *weight* of O and of a factor f is $w_O = m_s \deg_{K_s} f$ and $w_f = m_s \deg_{K_s} f$.

Dimensions over $\mathbb{F}_q$ are recovered from dimensions over K_s by $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} V = m_s \dim_{K_s} V$. We write u, z for indeterminates and work in $\mathbb{Z}[u, z]$.

3 Parametrization and the reciprocal operation

Theorem 3.1 (parametrization)**.** *The map $a \mapsto C_s(a) = \langle g_a \rangle$ is a bijection from $\{0, \dots, P\}^{\mathcal{F}_s}$ onto the set of λ_s-constacyclic codes of length n over K_s, and $\dim_{K_s} C_s(a) = n - \sum_f a_f \deg f$. Consequently there are $(P+1)^{\sum_s |\mathcal{F}_s|}$ labeled global assignments, and λ-constacyclic codes over A correspond to tuples of component assignments (Proposition 6.2).*

Proof. Ideals of $K_s[x]/(M_s)$ correspond to ideals $(M_s) \subseteq I$ of the principal ideal domain $K_s[x]$, hence to monic divisors $\bar{g}$ of M_s; by unique factorization and $M_s = \prod f^P$, monic divisors are exactly the g_a. For a monic divisor g of degree r, multiplication by g identifies $\langle g \rangle \subseteq K_s[x]/(M_s)$ with $K_s[x]/((M_s)/g)$, of dimension $n - r$. No separability hypothesis is used. □

Theorem 3.2 (the reciprocal operation)**.** *(i) $\#$ is multiplicative on monic polynomials with nonzero constant term; hence $\big(\prod_f f^{a_f}\big)^{\#} = \prod_f (f^{\#})^{a_f}$ for all exponents $a_f \geq 0$.*

(ii) If $f(\xi) = 0$ with $\xi \neq 0$ in an algebraic closure, then $f^{\#}\big(\xi^{-p^{d_s-k}}\big) = 0$; in fact $f^{\#}$ is the minimal polynomial of $\xi^{-p^{d_s-k}}$.

(iii) $\lambda_s^{1+p^{d_s-k}} = 1 \iff \mu_s^{1+p^{d_s-k}} = 1$. Under compatibility, τ_s permutes $\mathcal{F}_s$ and preserves degrees.

Proof. Let $\bar{\rho}$ be the coefficientwise extension of ρ to $K_s[x]$; it is a ring automorphism with inverse $\bar{\sigma}$. For (i), $\bar{\rho}(fg) = \bar{\rho}(f)\bar{\rho}(g)$, reversal $x^r f(1/x)$ is multiplicative in fixed degrees, and the normalizing constants multiply since $(fg)_0 = f_0 g_0$; combining the three gives $(fg)^{\#} = f^{\#} g^{\#}$, and induction on the number of factors gives the displayed identity. For (ii), apply the Frobenius map $t \mapsto t^{p^{d_s-k}}$ of the algebraic closure to $\sum c_i \xi^i = 0$ to get $\sum \rho(c_i) \beta^{-i} = 0$ for $\beta = \xi^{-p^{d_s-k}}$; multiplying by β^r yields $\rho(c_0) f^{\#}(\beta) = 0$. The same Frobenius transport preserves degrees of minimal polynomials, so $f^{\#}$ is the (monic irreducible) minimal polynomial of β. For (iii), $(\mu_s^{1+p^{d_s-k}})^P = \lambda_s^{1+p^{d_s-k}}$ and in characteristic p, $y^P = 1$ implies $y = 1$; now (ii) shows $\tau_s(f)$ is the minimal polynomial of a root β with $\beta^{n_0} = \rho(\mu_s)^{-1} = \mu_s$ (using compatibility in the form $\rho(\mu_s) = \mu_s^{-1}$), so $\tau_s(f) \mid \bar{M}_s$; bijectivity follows by applying the same construction with σ in place of ρ, which gives the inverse map. □

4 The Galois dual

The first step is a Euclidean-dual statement that uses no separability at all.

Lemma 4.1 (Euclidean dual generator)**.** *Let g be a monic divisor of $x^n - \lambda$, $\lambda \in K^*$, $h = (x^n - \lambda)/g$, $r = \deg g$, $s = n - r$, and $C = \langle g \rangle$ under the coefficient identification (this is the classical constacyclic dual statement; cf. [13, 18]). Then $h_0 \neq 0$, and with $h^{\natural}(x) = h_0^{-1} \sum_{i=0}^{s} h_i x^{s-i}$ (the ordinary reciprocal, without Frobenius), $C^{\perp} = \langle h^{\natural} \rangle$, a λ^{-1}-constacyclic code.*

Proof. From $gh = x^n - \lambda$, $g_0 h_0 = -\lambda \neq 0$. Both $\langle h^\natural \rangle$ and $C^\perp$ have dimension r: the first by the divisor dimension count of Theorem 3.1 (applied to any modulus), the second by rank–nullity. The boundary cases are immediate from the definitions: if $r = 0$, then $g = 1$, $C = K^n$ and $C^\perp = \{0\}$, while $h^\natural$ has degree n and hence no nonzero multiple of degree $< n$; if $s = 0$, then $h = 1$, $C = \{0\}$ and $C^\perp = K^n$, while $h^\natural = 1$. Assume $r, s \geq 1$ below, so that V is defined (and $v = 0$ gives $d = 0$). We show orthogonality. For polynomials a, d of degree $< n$, write $\mathrm{rev}_n(d) = x^{n-1} d(1/x)$; then $\sum_i a_i d_i = [x^{n-1}]\big(a(x)\,\mathrm{rev}_n(d)(x)\big)$. Take $a = gu$, $\deg u < s$, and $d = h^\natural v$, $\deg v < r$. Since $h^\natural(1/x) = h_0^{-1} x^{-s} h(x)$, one computes $\mathrm{rev}_n(d) = h_0^{-1} h(x) V(x)$ with $V(x) = x^{r-1} v(1/x)$, $\deg V \leq r - 1$. Hence $a(x)\,\mathrm{rev}_n(d)(x) = h_0^{-1}(x^n - \lambda) u(x) V(x)$ with $\deg(uV) \leq n - 2$; the coefficient of x^{n-1} is 0. Thus $\langle h^\natural \rangle \subseteq C^\perp$, and equality follows by dimensions. That $h^\natural \mid x^n - \lambda^{-1}$ follows from $(gh)^* = g^* h^* = -\lambda(x^n - \lambda^{-1})$ for the unnormalized reciprocal $\phi^*(x) = x^{\deg \phi} \phi(1/x)$. □

Proposition 4.2 (transport by ρ)**.** *Let the field be $\mathbb{F}_{p^d}$, with σ, ρ as in Section 2. For every $\mathbb{F}_{p^d}$-linear code $C \subseteq \mathbb{F}_{p^d}^n$, $D(C) = \rho(C^\perp)$ (coordinatewise). Consequently, for $C = \langle g \rangle \subseteq \mathbb{F}_{p^d}[x]/(x^n - \lambda)$ and $h = (x^n - \lambda)/g$, $D(C) = \langle h^\# \rangle \subseteq \mathbb{F}_{p^d}[x]/(x^n - \lambda^{-p^{d-k}})$; if λ is compatible, the modulus is again $x^n - \lambda$.*

Proof. By the code-first definition, $y \in D(C)$ iff $\sum_i c_i \sigma(y_i) = 0$ for all $c \in C$, i.e. iff $\sigma(y) \in C^\perp$ (coordinatewise), i.e. iff $y \in \rho(C^\perp)$ since $\rho = \sigma^{-1}$; this is exactly where the slot order enters. Coefficientwise application of an automorphism sends the ideal $\langle e \rangle$ in $K[x]/(x^n - \eta)$ to $\langle \bar{\rho}(e) \rangle$ in $K[x]/(x^n - \rho(\eta))$; applying this to Lemma 4.1 and comparing $\bar{\rho}(h^\natural)$ with $h^\#$ gives the generator. Compatibility $\lambda^{1+p^{d-k}} = 1$ gives $\lambda^{-p^{d-k}} = \lambda$. □

Theorem 4.3 (dual exponents)**.** *For every assignment a, with $h_a = M_s/g_a$, $D(C_s(a)) = \langle h_a^\# \rangle$; under compatibility this is a λ_s-constacyclic code in the same quotient. On a τ_s-orbit $O = (f_0, \ldots, f_{L-1})$ with $\alpha_i = a_{f_i}$, the exponent of f_i in $h_a^\#$ is*

$$\beta_i \;=\; P - \alpha_{i-1} \qquad (\textit{indices mod } L).$$

Proof. The generator statement is Proposition 4.2. For the exponents, $h_a = \prod_f f^{P - a_f}$, so by Theorem 3.2(i) and the permutation property, $h_a^\# = \prod_f (\tau_s f)^{P - a_f} = \prod_g g^{P - a_{\tau_s^{-1} g}}$; for $g = f_i$, $\tau_s^{-1}(f_i) = f_{i-1}$, giving $P - \alpha_{i-1}$. □

Remark. Without compatibility, $D(C_s(a)) = \langle h_a^\# \rangle$ and the exponent formula remain valid, but in the modulus $x^n - \lambda_s^{-p^{d_s - k}}$. Compatibility is what allows the dual to be viewed inside the same constacyclic family; it cannot simply be dropped (e.g. in $\mathbb{F}_9$ with $k = 1$, a twist λ of order 8 satisfies $\lambda^{1+3} = \lambda^4 = -1 \neq 1$ and indeed $\lambda^{-3} \neq \lambda$).

5 The Galois hull

Lemma 5.1 (intersection of ideals)**.** *For monic divisors g, l of a monic $M \in K[x]$, the images of (g) and (l) in $K[x]/(M)$ intersect in the image of $(\mathrm{lcm}(g, l))$, and $\mathrm{lcm}(g, l) = \prod_\pi \pi^{\max(v_\pi(g), v_\pi(l))}$.*

Proof. In $K[x]$, $(g) \cap (l) = (\mathrm{lcm}(g, l))$ since both consist of the common multiples of g and l, characterized valuation-wise by the displayed maximum. If y lies in both images in the quotient, any lift Y satisfies $Y \in (g)$ and $Y \in (l)$ because $(M) \subseteq (g), (l)$; hence $Y \in (\mathrm{lcm}(g, l))$. The reverse inclusion is immediate from $g, l \mid \mathrm{lcm}(g, l)$. □

Theorem 5.2 (hull generator and dimensions)**.** *Under compatibility, for every assignment a,* $\mathrm{Hull}_k(C_s(a)) = \langle \mathrm{lcm}(g_a, h_a^{\#}) \rangle$*, the exponent of f_i in the hull generator being* $\max(\alpha_i, P-\alpha_{i-1})$*. Moreover*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a) \;=\; \sum_s \sum_O w_O \sum_i (P-\alpha_i), \qquad \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C(a)) \;=\; \sum_s \sum_O w_O \sum_i \min(P-\alpha_i,\, \alpha_{i-1}),$$

the inner sums over orbit positions (indices mod L_O); here and below, α_i refers to the orbit (s, O) under discussion.

Proof. Work in one component. By Theorems 3.1 and 4.3, $C(a)$ and $D(C(a))$ are the images of (g_a) and $(h_a^{\#})$, both dividing $M = x^n - \lambda$; Lemma 5.1 gives the hull generator, whose f_i-exponent is $\max(\alpha_i, \beta_i) = \max(\alpha_i, P - \alpha_{i-1})$. Dimensions are $n - \deg(\text{generator})$ over K; grouping factors by orbits (constant degree on an orbit) and using $P - \max(u, v) = \min(P - u, P - v)$ with $v = P - \alpha_{i-1}$ gives the hull formula; multiplication by m_s and summation over s gives the $\mathbb{F}_q$-dimensions. □

Remark (relation to [8])*.* For a single component ($N = 1$), Theorem 5.2 recovers [8, Theorem 3]: with $P = p^\nu$ and cycle contribution $a_t P - \sum_i \max(u_i, P - u_{i-1})$, the identity $P - \max(u, P - v) = \min(P - u, v)$ identifies their summand with $\sum_i \min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$ above, the factor degree $\mathrm{ord}_j(q)$ being our orbit weight w_O. Their counting result [8, Theorem 4] is restricted to reciprocal-orbit lengths $1, 2$ and 4 and counts by hull dimension alone; the joint enumerator below imposes no restriction on orbit length and records both dimensions.

6 The transfer-matrix enumerator

For $P \geq 1$, $w \geq 1$, define the $(P{+}1) \times (P{+}1)$ matrix over $\mathbb{Z}[u, z]$

$$T_w^{(P)}(u, z)_{a,b} \;=\; u^{\,w(P-b)}\, z^{\,w \min(P-b,\, a)}, \qquad a, b \in \{0, \ldots, P\},$$

the row index a being the previous exponent and the column index b the current one.

Theorem 6.1 (local transfer trace)**.** *For a τ_s-orbit O of length L and weight w,*

$$\mathrm{tr}\big(T_w^{(P)}(u, z)^L\big) \;=\; \sum_{\alpha \in \{0,\ldots,P\}^L} u^{\,w \sum_i (P-\alpha_i)}\, z^{\,w \sum_i \min(P-\alpha_i,\, \alpha_{i-1})}, \quad \textit{indices mod } L.$$

Proof. Expanding the matrix power, $(T^L)_{a_0, a_L} = \sum_{a_1, \ldots, a_{L-1}} \prod_{j=1}^{L} T_{a_{j-1}, a_j}$; setting $a_L = a_0$ and summing over a_0 gives $\mathrm{tr}(T^L) = \sum_{a_0, \ldots, a_{L-1}} \prod_{j=1}^{L} T_{a_{j-1}, a_j}$. These closed walks are in bijection with assignments $\alpha = (\alpha_0, \ldots, \alpha_{L-1})$ (orbit positions are labeled; a walk and its rotation are different assignments). The j-th edge contributes $u^{w(P-a_j)} z^{w \min(P-a_j, a_{j-1})}$; summing exponents over the walk and reindexing gives the claim. For $L = 1$ the single edge is the self-loop $a_0 \to a_0$ and the formula reads $\sum_a u^{w(P-a)} z^{w \min(P-a, a)}$, as required. □

Proposition 6.2 (product assembly)**.** *Ideals of $A[x]/(x^n - \lambda) \cong \prod_s K_s[x]/(x^n - \lambda_s)$ are exactly the products of component ideals; the global dual and hull decompose componentwise; and* $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = \sum_s m_s \dim_{K_s} C_s$*, likewise for the hull.*

Proof. The ring isomorphism is coefficientwise; quotienting a product by the product ideal $(x^n - \lambda_s)_s$ gives the product of quotients (this is the direct-product structure of the square-free algebra A itself; no coprimality between components is involved). Ideals of a finite product of rings are products of ideals (project, and recover the components with the idempotents of A). The pairing is componentwise and vanishes exactly when every component does, giving the dual and hull statements; dimensions add over the direct sum $A^n \cong \bigoplus_s K_s^n$ with the factor $[K_s : \mathbb{F}_q] = m_s$. □

Theorem 6.3 (joint enumerator)**.** *Under the standing hypotheses (common P, n, k; compatible twists; labeled components),*

$$\mathcal{E}(u,z) \;:=\; \sum_{\text{labeled } a} u^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a)}\, z^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C(a))} \;=\; \prod_{s=1}^{N} \prod_{O\in\mathcal{O}_s} \mathrm{tr}\Big(T_{w_O}^{(P)}(u,z)^{L_O}\Big),$$

where $\mathcal{O}_s$ is the set of τ_s-orbits. The coefficient of $u^K z^H$ is the number of labeled assignments with $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = K$ and $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C) = H$.

Proof. By Theorem 3.1 and Proposition 6.2, a global assignment is the disjoint union of its orbit restrictions $\alpha^{(O)} \in \{0,\dots,P\}^{L_O}$, and by Theorem 5.2 each of the two dimensions is a sum over (s,O) of a quantity depending only on $\alpha^{(O)}$. The finite distributive law (expanding a product of sums over a Cartesian product index set) factorizes the global sum into the product of the orbit sums $\mathcal{E}_O(u,z) = \sum_\alpha u^{w_O \sum (P-\alpha_i)} z^{w_O \sum \min(P-\alpha_i,\alpha_{i-1})}$, and Theorem 6.1 identifies $\mathcal{E}_O(u,z) = \mathrm{tr}(T_{w_O}^{(P)}(u,z)^{L_O})$. □

Corollary 6.4 (joint symmetry of the enumerator)**.** *Put $\Delta := \sum_{s,O} P w_O L_O = n \sum_s m_s$ (indeed, for each component s, $\sum_{O\in\mathcal{O}_s} w_O L_O = m_s n_0$, since the degrees of the distinct irreducible factors of $\bar{M}_s$ sum to n_0; hence Δ is the maximum, and ambient, $\mathbb{F}_q$-dimension). Then for all integers K, H,*

$$\#\{a : (\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a), \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C(a))) = (K,H)\} = \#\{a : (\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a), \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C(a))) = (\Delta-K,H)\},$$

equivalently $\mathcal{E}(u,z) = u^\Delta \mathcal{E}(u^{-1},z)$. In particular, for every K the multiset of hull dimensions over the assignments with $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = K$ equals that over the assignments with $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = \Delta - K$.

Proof. It suffices to argue on one orbit O of length L and weight w; the global statement follows by summing over orbits. Define $\alpha'_i = P - \alpha_{-i}$ (indices mod L). This is an involution of $\{0,\dots,P\}^L$: applying it twice returns α_i. Its code contribution is $w\sum_i (P-\alpha'_i) = w\sum_i \alpha_{-i} = w\sum_i \alpha_i = PwL - w\sum_i (P-\alpha_i)$, so K maps to $PwL - K$. Its hull contribution satisfies, with the reindexing $j = -i+1$, $\min(P-\alpha'_i, \alpha'_{i-1}) = \min(\alpha_{-i}, P-\alpha_{-i+1}) = \min(P-\alpha_j, \alpha_{j-1})$, term by term equal to the hull sum of α. Hence the involution pairs tuples of joint type (K,H) with tuples of type $(PwL-K,H)$, proving the per-orbit coefficient identity; the product over all orbits (Theorem 6.3) gives the claim with $\Delta = \sum_O P w_O L_O$. □

Remark (hypotheses of the identity). As an identity in $\mathbb{Z}[u,z]$, Theorem 6.1 holds for every integer $P \geq 1$; that P is a power of p is needed for the field construction behind Theorems 3.1–5.2, not for the matrix identity. The enumerator counts labeled assignments; the trace formula is insensitive to reversing the orbit orientation. Indeed the hull dimension of every individual assignment is unchanged under reversal, because $\min(P-a,b) - \min(P-b,a) = b-a$ telescopes to 0 around the orbit; hence no statistic of Sections 7 and 8 can detect the orientation. The predecessor convention α_{i-1} in Theorem 5.2 is nevertheless essential for identifying the hull *generator*, and is fixed by the code-first pairing of Section 2.

Proposition 6.5 (simple-root recovery at $P=1$)**.** *At $P = 1$, assignments are binary, g_a is a squarefree divisor, the hull edge term $\min(1-\alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$ is the indicator of the transition $1 \to 0$ along the orbit, and*

$$T_w^{(1)}(u,z) \;=\; \begin{pmatrix} u^w & 1 \\ u^w z^w & 1 \end{pmatrix} \qquad (\textit{rows/columns } a,b \in \{0,1\}),$$

so Theorem 6.3 specializes to the binary-state simple-root joint enumerator with the same conventions.

Proof. For $P=1$, $\min(1-b,a)$ is 1 exactly for $(a,b) = (1,0)$; reading off the four entries gives the matrix, and $\mu_s = \lambda_s$, $\bar{M}_s = M_s$ gives the squarefree parametrization. □

7 Counting corollaries

Corollary 7.1 (total count)**.** $\mathcal{E}(1,1) = (P+1)^{\sum_s |\mathcal{F}_s|}$.

Proof. At $u = z = 1$ each $T_w^{(P)}$ is the all-ones matrix J with $J^L = (P+1)^{L-1}J$, so $\operatorname{tr}(J^{L_O}) = (P+1)^{L_O}$; product over orbits gives $(P+1)^{\sum_s \sum_O L_O} = (P+1)^{\sum_s |\mathcal{F}_s|}$. □

Corollary 7.2 (code-dimension distribution)**.** $\mathcal{E}(u,1) = \prod_s \prod_{f \in \mathcal{F}_s} \left(1 + u^{w_f} + \cdots + u^{Pw_f}\right)$.

Proof. At $z = 1$ the entry $T_{a,b} = u^{w(P-b)}$ is independent of the row, so $T = c\,r$ is rank one with $r \cdot c = \sum_{j=0}^{P} u^{wj}$; then $\operatorname{tr}(T^L) = (r \cdot c)^{L-1} \operatorname{tr}(T) = \left(\sum_{j=0}^{P} u^{wj}\right)^L$. Within an orbit all w_f equal w_O, giving $\prod_{f \in O}(1 + u^{w_f} + \cdots + u^{Pw_f})$ per orbit. □

Corollary 7.3 (LCD count)**.** *The number of labeled assignments with* $\operatorname{Hull}_k(C(a)) = 0$ *is* $2^{\#orbits}$*, independent of* P*.*

Proof. The hull dimension is a sum of nonnegative terms $w_O \min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$; it vanishes iff every orbit satisfies $\min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1}) = 0$ for all i. On one orbit, if some $\alpha_m \notin \{0, P\}$ (so $P \geq 2$), then $\min(P - \alpha_{m+1}, \alpha_m) = 0$ with $\alpha_m > 0$ forces $\alpha_{m+1} = P$, and inductively every $\alpha_i = P$ around the cycle, a contradiction (for $L = 1$, $\min(P - \alpha_0, \alpha_0) = 0$ already forces $\alpha_0 \in \{0, P\}$). Hence each $\alpha_i \in \{0, P\}$; if both values occurred, at a boundary position with $\alpha_i = 0$, $\alpha_{i-1} = P$ the term would be $\min(P, P) = P \geq 1$. So exactly two tuples per orbit ($\alpha \equiv 0$ or $\alpha \equiv P$), independently across orbits. □

Corollary 7.4 (LCD refinement: the code dimension of LCD assignments)**.** *With* Δ *as in Corollary 6.4,*

$$\sum_{a\,:\,\operatorname{Hull}_k(C(a))=0} u^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a)} \;=\; \prod_s \prod_{O \in \mathcal{O}_s} \left(1 + u^{P w_O L_O}\right).$$

Consequently, under the uniform distribution on labeled assignments, conditionally on $\operatorname{Hull}_k(C(a)) = 0$ *the code dimension is distributed as* $\sum_O (P w_O L_O)\,\xi_O$ *with independent* $\xi_O \sim \text{Bernoulli}(1/2)$*; in particular* $\mathbb{E}[\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C \mid \operatorname{Hull}_k(C) = 0] = \Delta/2$ *and* $\operatorname{Var}(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C \mid \operatorname{Hull}_k(C) = 0) = \frac{P^2}{4} \sum_O (w_O L_O)^2$.

Proof. By Corollary 7.3, $\operatorname{Hull}_k(C(a)) = 0$ if and only if every orbit restriction is constant, $\alpha \equiv 0$ or $\alpha \equiv P$; these two tuples have code contributions $P w_O L_O$ and 0 respectively (Theorem 5.2), giving the displayed product by independence across orbits. Conditioning the uniform distribution on this product event keeps the orbits independent with the two options equally likely, which is the stated Bernoulli sum; its mean is $\frac{1}{2} \sum_O P w_O L_O = \Delta/2$ and its variance is $\sum_O (P w_O L_O)^2 \cdot \frac{1}{4}$. □

Corollary 7.5 (self-orthogonal and dual-containing codes)**.** $C(a) \subseteq D(C(a))$ *if and only if* $\alpha_{i-1} + \alpha_i \geq P$ *on every orbit edge, and then the count is* $\prod_O \operatorname{tr}(B_P^{L_O})$ *with* $(B_P)_{a,b} = 1$ *iff* $a + b \geq P$*. Dually,* $D(C(a)) \subseteq C(a)$ *if and only if* $\alpha_{i-1} + \alpha_i \leq P$ *on every edge, with count* $\prod_O \operatorname{tr}((B'_P)^{L_O})$*,* $(B'_P)_{a,b} = 1$ *iff* $a + b \leq P$*. The two counts are equal.*

Proof. Since $\text{Hull} = C \cap D(C) \subseteq C$, $C \subseteq D(C)$ iff $\dim \text{Hull} = \dim C$. By Theorem 5.2, $\dim C - \dim \text{Hull} = \sum_{s,O} w_O \sum_i \max(0, P - \alpha_i - \alpha_{i-1})$ because $(P - \alpha_i) - \min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1}) = \max(0, P - \alpha_i - \alpha_{i-1})$; every summand is nonnegative, so the total vanishes iff every edge satisfies $\alpha_{i-1} + \alpha_i \geq P$. The admissible tuples on one orbit are the closed walks of the 0-1 matrix B_P, counted by $\operatorname{tr}(B_P^{L_O})$ as in Theorem 6.1. For the dual side, $\dim D(C) = \sum w_O \sum_i \alpha_{i-1} = \sum w_O \sum_i \alpha_i$ by Theorem 4.3, and $\alpha_{i-1} - \min(P - \alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1}) = \max(0, \alpha_i + \alpha_{i-1} - P)$; the same argument gives the condition $\alpha_{i-1} + \alpha_i \leq P$ and the count $\operatorname{tr}((B'_P)^{L_O})$. The involution $\alpha_i \mapsto P - \alpha_i$ maps one edge condition to the other, so the counts agree. □

Corollary 7.6 (restricted enumerators for the self-orthogonal and dual-containing families)**.** *For an orbit of length L and weight w, define matrices over $\mathbb{Z}[t]$ and $\mathbb{Z}[u,z]$ by*

$$\big(A_w^{\mathrm{SO}}(t)\big)_{a,b} = \begin{cases} t^{\,w(P-b)}, & a+b \geq P, \\ 0, & a+b < P, \end{cases} \qquad \big(A_w^{\mathrm{DC}}(u,z)\big)_{a,b} = \begin{cases} u^{\,w(P-b)} z^{\,wa}, & a+b \leq P, \\ 0, & a+b > P, \end{cases}$$

the row index a being the previous exponent and the column index b the current one, as in Theorem 6.1. Then

$$\sum_{a\,:\,C(a)\subseteq D(C(a))} t^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a)} = \prod_s \prod_{O\in\mathcal{O}_s} \mathrm{tr}\Big(\big(A_{w_O}^{\mathrm{SO}}(t)\big)^{L_O}\Big),$$

whose specialization $t = uz$ is the joint enumerator of the self-orthogonal family (there $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\mathrm{Hull}_k = \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C$), and

$$\sum_{a\,:\,D(C(a))\subseteq C(a)} u^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C(a)} z^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\mathrm{Hull}_k(C(a))} = \prod_s \prod_{O\in\mathcal{O}_s} \mathrm{tr}\Big(\big(A_{w_O}^{\mathrm{DC}}(u,z)\big)^{L_O}\Big).$$

Writing $N_{\mathrm{SO}}(K)$ for the number of self-orthogonal assignments with $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = K$ and $N_{\mathrm{DC}}(K,H)$ for the number of dual-containing assignments with $(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C, \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\mathrm{Hull}_k) = (K,H)$, one has $N_{\mathrm{SO}}(K) = N_{\mathrm{DC}}(\Delta-K,K)$ for all K. At $u=z=1$ the two enumerators reduce to the two counts of Corollary 7.5.

Proof. Both admissibility conditions are those of Corollary 7.5, and both dimensions are sums over orbits, so by the closed-walk expansion of Theorem 6.1 it suffices to check one orbit. On a self-orthogonal tuple, $\mathrm{Hull}_k(C) = C$, so the joint weight is $(uz)^{\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C}$; along an edge $a \to b$ the code contribution is $w(P-b)$ and admissibility is $a+b \geq P$, which is exactly the weight built into A_w^{SO}. On a dual-containing tuple, $\mathrm{Hull}_k(C) = D(C)$, whose per-orbit dimension is $w\sum_i \alpha_i = w\sum_i \alpha_{i-1}$ (proof of Corollary 7.5); the edge $a \to b$ therefore carries code weight $w(P-b)$ (from b) and hull weight wa (from the previous exponent), with admissibility $a+b \leq P$, as in A_w^{DC}. The trace includes the closing edge, i.e. the orbit-boundary condition. For the symmetry, the per-orbit complement $\alpha_i \mapsto P-\alpha_i$ maps the self-orthogonal condition to the dual-containing condition bijectively, sends $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = K$ to $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = \Delta - K$, and sends the hull dimension to $\sum_O w_O \sum_i (P-\alpha_i) = K$. □

8 Moments of the hull dimension

The model. By Theorem 3.1, labeled assignments are in bijection with the labeled constacyclic codes of the given length, alphabet and twist; we therefore put the uniform measure on assignments, equivalently on the codes of this family itself (not on random linear codes). The mean and variance below are the exact ensemble averages of $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\mathrm{Hull}_k$ over this family. Since $\mu_P/P \to 1/3$ as $P \to \infty$ (and $\mu_1 = 1/4$), the mean hull dimension is a positive proportion of the ambient dimension Δ — roughly $\Delta/3$ for large P, $\Delta/4$ at $P=1$, apart from the length-one-orbit correction — so the typical code of the family has a hull growing linearly with n, in contrast to random linear codes, whose hull dimension stays bounded in probability [19]. The variance formulas quantify the fluctuations around this behaviour. Comparisons with average-dimension formulas in the literature should be made only under matching hypotheses; the results below are stated strictly for the labeled repeated-root ensemble defined here.

Choose a labeled assignment uniformly at random; equivalently, all exponents A_i (over all components, orbits, positions) are independent and uniform on $\{0,\dots,P\}$. For one orbit write $X_i = \min(P-A_i, A_{i-1})$ (indices mod L) and $S_L = \sum_i X_i$; the orbit contributes $w_O S_{L_O}$ to $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\mathrm{Hull}_k$ (Theorem 5.2). Set

$$\mu_P = \frac{P(2P+1)}{6(P+1)}, \qquad \nu_P = \frac{\lfloor P^2/4 \rfloor}{P+1}.$$

Lemma 8.1 (edge moments)**.** *For independent U, V uniform on $\{0, \dots, P\}$, $\mathbb{E}[\min(U,V)] = \mu_P$ and $\mathbb{E}[\min(U,V)^2] = \frac{P(P^2+P+1)}{6(P+1)}$. For $0 \le c \le P$, $F(c) := \mathbb{E}[\min(c,U)] = \frac{c(2P-c+1)}{2(P+1)}$.*

Proof. For a nonnegative integer variable, $\mathbb{E}[X] = \sum_{t\ge1} \Pr(X \ge t)$ and $\mathbb{E}[X^2] = \sum_{t\ge1}(2t-1)\Pr(X \ge t)$. Here $\Pr(\min(U,V) \ge t) = ((P-t+1)/(P+1))^2$ for $1 \le t \le P$; summing via $\sum_{r=1}^{P} r^2 = P(P+1)(2P+1)/6$ and $\sum r^3 = (P(P+1)/2)^2$ gives both formulas. The last claim is $F(c) = \sum_{t=1}^{c}(P-t+1)/(P+1)$. □

Theorem 8.2 (means)**.** $\mathbb{E}[\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C] = \dfrac{n}{2}\sum_s m_s$, *and*

$$\mathbb{E}[\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C)] \;=\; \nu_P \sum_{O:\, L_O=1} w_O \;+\; \mu_P \sum_{O:\, L_O\ge 2} w_O L_O.$$

Proof. $\mathbb{E}[P - A_f] = P/2$ and $\sum_{f\in\mathcal{F}_s} \deg f = n_0$ give the first formula via Theorem 5.2. For the hull, linearity over orbits reduces to $\mathbb{E}[S_L]$. If $L \ge 2$, each X_i is the minimum of two independent uniforms (for $L = 2$, X_0, X_1 are the two ordered pairings of the same two distinct variables), so $\mathbb{E}[S_L] = L\mu_P$ by Lemma 8.1. If $L = 1$, $\mathbb{E}[S_1] = \frac{1}{P+1}\sum_{a=0}^{P} \min(P-a, a)$; the summands are symmetric under $a \mapsto P-a$, giving $P^2/4$ for $P = 2m$ and $(P^2-1)/4$ for $P = 2m+1$, i.e. $\lfloor P^2/4 \rfloor$; hence $\mathbb{E}[S_1] = \nu_P$. Note $\nu_1 = 0$: at $P = 1$ an $L_O = 1$ orbit contributes nothing, and $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{Hull}] = \frac{1}{4}\sum_{L_O\ge2} w_O L_O$. □

Remark (relation to [4]). For a single component ($N = 1$, $K_s = \mathbb{F}_q$), the hull mean above agrees with [4, Theorem 3.3]: writing Δ_t for the sum of the degrees of the distinct factors in reciprocal cycles of length a_t (so $\sum_t a_t\Delta_t = n_0$), their Formula simplifies, via $P - \frac{P(4P+5)}{6(P+1)} = \mu_P$ and $P - \frac{3P+1}{4} + \frac{\delta_P}{4(P+1)} = \nu_P$, to $\nu_P\Delta_1 + \mu_P\sum_{t\ge2} a_t\Delta_t$, which is the display above. No variance or covariance formula is given there; the second-order results below (Theorem 8.4 and Corollary 8.5) have no counterpart in [4].

For the variance, orbit contributions are independent (disjoint exponent variables), so with $V_L(P) := \mathrm{Var}(S_L)$, $\mathrm{Var}(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k) = \sum_{s,O} w_O^2 V_{L_O}(P)$; note the squared weights, in contrast to the mean.

Lemma 8.3 (variance pieces)**.** *(i) $L = 1$: $V_1(P) = \dfrac{P(P+2)(P^2+2P+4)}{48(P+1)^2}$ if P is even, and $V_1(P) = \dfrac{(P-1)(P+3)}{48}$ if P is odd.*

(ii) For $L \ge 3$, two adjacent edges satisfy $\mathrm{Cov}(X_i, X_{i+1}) = \kappa_P < 0$, where $\kappa_P = -\frac{P(P+2)(7P^2+14P+9)}{360(P+1)^2}$, while non-adjacent edge pairs are independent.

(iii) For $L = 2$: $\mathbb{E}[X_0X_1] = \dfrac{P^2(P-1)}{12(P+1)}$ and $\mathrm{Cov}(X_0, X_1) = -\dfrac{P^2(P+2)^2}{36(P+1)^2}$.

Proof. (i) $\mathbb{E}[\min(P-A, A)^2] = \frac{1}{P+1}\sum_a \min(P-a,a)^2$; for $P = 2m$ the squared values are $0^2, \dots, (m-1)^2, m^2, (m-1)^2, \dots, 0^2$, summing to $m(2m^2+1)/3$, and for $P = 2m+1$ each of $0^2, \dots, m^2$ occurs twice, summing to $m(m+1)(2m+1)/3$; subtracting ν_P^2 (Theorem 8.2) and simplifying gives the claim. (ii) X_i, X_{i+1} share exactly the variable A_i. Conditioning on $A_i = b$ makes them conditionally independent with means $F(P-b)$ and $F(b)$ (Lemma 8.1), so $\mathbb{E}[X_iX_{i+1}] = \frac{1}{P+1}\sum_{b=0}^{P} F(P-b)F(b) = \frac{P(P-1)(11P^2+15P+6)}{120(P+1)^2}$ by the power sums $\sum b^j$, $j \le 4$; subtracting μ_P^2 gives κ_P, negative for $P \ge 1$. Non-adjacent edges depend on disjoint pairs of variables, hence are independent. (iii) $X_0 \ge s$ and $X_1 \ge t$ hold simultaneously iff $s + t \le P$, in which case each of the two variables has $P - s - t + 1$ admissible values; thus $\mathbb{E}[X_0X_1] = \sum_{s,t\ge1} \Pr(X_0 \ge s, X_1 \ge t) = \frac{1}{(P+1)^2}\sum_{r=1}^{P-1}(P-r)r^2 = \frac{P^2(P-1)}{12(P+1)}$, and subtracting μ_P^2 gives the covariance. □

Theorem 8.4 (variance of the hull dimension)**.** $\operatorname{Var}\big(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\operatorname{Hull}_k(C)\big) = \sum_s \sum_{O\in\mathcal{O}_s} w_O^2\, V_{L_O}(P)$, *where*

$$V_1(P) \text{ is as in Lemma 8.3(i)},$$
$$V_2(P) = \frac{P(P+2)(P^2+2P+3)}{18(P+1)^2},$$
$$V_L(P) = \frac{L\,P(P+2)(P^2+2P+2)}{60(P+1)^2} \qquad (L\ge 3).$$

Proof. Independence across orbits gives the weighted sum. For one orbit: $L=1$ is Lemma 8.3(i). For $L=2$, $\operatorname{Var}(S_2) = 2\operatorname{Var}(X) + 2\operatorname{Cov}(X_0,X_1)$; with $\operatorname{Var}(X) = \frac{P(P+2)(2P^2+4P+3)}{36(P+1)^2}$ (from Lemma 8.1) and (iii), the bracket factors as $P(P+2)(P^2+2P+3)$, giving $V_2(P)$. For $L\ge 3$, $\operatorname{Var}(S_L) = L\operatorname{Var}(X) + 2L\kappa_P$ (exactly the L adjacent pairs contribute, by (ii)), and $\operatorname{Var}(X) + 2\kappa_P = \frac{P(P+2)(P^2+2P+2)}{60(P+1)^2}$. At $P=1$: $V_1(1)=0$, $V_2(1)=1/4$, $V_L(1)=L/16$. The $L=2$ formula is not the $L\ge 3$ formula evaluated at $L=2$ (at $P=2$: $44/81$ versus $8/27$), because the two edges of a 2-orbit share both variables. □

Corollary 8.5 (second-order structure of the two dimensions)**.** *Under the uniform model of this section,*

$$\operatorname{Var}\big(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C\big) = \frac{P(P+2)}{12}\sum_s\sum_{f\in\mathcal{F}_s} w_f^2, \qquad \operatorname{Cov}\big(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C,\, \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q}\operatorname{Hull}_k(C)\big) = 0.$$

In particular, the two dimensions are uncorrelated (they need not be independent).

Proof. By Theorem 5.2, $\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C = \sum_{s,f} w_f(P-A_f)$ with independent A_f uniform on $\{0,\dots,P\}$, and $\operatorname{Var}(P-A_f) = P(P+2)/12$, giving the variance formula. For the covariance, orbit blocks are independent, so it suffices to consider one orbit with $K_O = \sum_i (P-A_i)$ and $S_O = \sum_j X_j$. In $\operatorname{Cov}(K_O, S_O)$, a term $\operatorname{Cov}(P-A_i, X_j)$ can be nonzero only for $i\in\{j, j-1\}$. With $\gamma_P := \operatorname{Cov}(B, \min(B,C)) = P(P+2)/24$ for independent B, C uniform on $\{0,\dots,P\}$ (a direct power-sum computation), the terms $i=j$ and $i=j-1$ contribute $+\gamma_P$ and $-\gamma_P$ respectively when $L\ge 2$; for $L=1$, symmetry under $A\mapsto P-A$ gives covariance 0 directly. Hence each orbit contributes 0, and summing with the weights w_O^2 gives $\operatorname{Cov}=0$. □

9 Examples and computational verification

The six examples are arranged so that each one makes a different part of the theory visible. Example 9.1 is small enough to check by hand and shows how a single exponent tuple produces its two coordinates. Example 9.2 isolates the simple-root specialization. Examples 9.3 and 9.4 leave the orbit model and compare the exponent formulas with ranks of Gram matrices of explicitly constructed codes, first for mixed orbit lengths and then for a long orbit. Example 9.5 tests the product assembly over two components, and Example 9.6 leaves the cyclic case $\lambda = 1$ used in Examples 9.3–9.5 and works with a compatible twist of order four. Throughout, K denotes the code-dimension coordinate and H the hull-dimension coordinate of a labeled assignment.

Example 9.1 (one orbit, $P=2$, $L=2$, $w=1$, by hand)**.** This example shows the bookkeeping of Theorem 5.2 in the smallest repeated-root case. The two positions form one orbit, and for $\alpha = (\alpha_0,\alpha_1)$ the two coordinates are $K = \sum_i(2-\alpha_i)$ and $H = \sum_i \min(2-\alpha_i, \alpha_{i-1})$. For instance, for $\alpha = (0,1)$ one gets $K = (2-0)+(2-1) = 3$ and $H = \min(2,1)+\min(1,0) = 1$;

the first edge contributes because the predecessor exponent is positive, while the second edge contributes nothing because its predecessor exponent is 0. Evaluating all nine tuples gives

$$(0,0)\mapsto(4,0),\quad (0,1)\mapsto(3,1),\quad (0,2)\mapsto(2,2),\quad (1,0)\mapsto(3,1),\quad (1,1)\mapsto(2,2),$$
$$(1,2)\mapsto(1,1),\quad (2,0)\mapsto(2,2),\quad (2,1)\mapsto(1,1),\quad (2,2)\mapsto(0,0).$$

Grouping equal pairs yields the joint distribution $\{(4,0):1,(3,1):2,(2,2):3,(1,1):2,(0,0):1\}$. Two features are already visible. First, the multiplicities are symmetric under $K \leftrightarrow 4-K$ at fixed H, as Corollary 6.4 requires for this orbit (here $\Delta = PwL = 4$). Second, the moments can be read off directly: $\mathbb{E}[S_2] = (0\cdot 1 + 1\cdot 2 + 2\cdot 3 + 1\cdot 2 + 0\cdot 1)/9 = 10/9 = 2\mu_2$, and $\mathrm{Var}(S_2) = 44/81 = V_2(2)$, the $L = 2$ case of Theorem 8.4. The separate $L = 2$ formula is essential here: the two edges of a 2-orbit share both variables, and formally inserting $L = 2$ into the $L \geq 3$ formula would give the incorrect value $8/27$. Finally, exactly two assignments, $\alpha \equiv 0$ and $\alpha \equiv P$, have hull contribution 0, as Corollary 7.3 requires per orbit.

Example 9.2 (simple-root orbit, $P = 1$, $L = 3$, $w = 1$)**.** At $P = 1$ the exponents are binary and the example checks the simple-root specialization of Proposition 6.5. The code coordinate is the number of zeros, $K = \sum_i (1 - \alpha_i)$, while the hull coordinate counts the cyclic transitions $1 \to 0$. The two constant words behave exceptionally: 000 gives $(K, H) = (3, 0)$ and 111 gives $(0, 0)$. Every non-constant binary word of length 3, viewed cyclically, has exactly one block of ones and one block of zeros, hence exactly one $1 \to 0$ transition and $H = 1$. There are three words of weight 1 (so $K = 2$) and three of weight 2 (so $K = 1$). Therefore the joint distribution is $\{(0,0):1,\ (1,1):3,\ (2,1):3,\ (3,0):1\}$, from which $\mathbb{E} = 3/4 = 3\mu_1$ and $\mathrm{Var} = 3/16 = V_3(1)$ follow immediately. The table also displays the symmetry of Corollary 6.4 in its smallest form: the hull multiplicity at $K = 0$ equals that at $K = 3$, and the multiplicity at $K = 1$ equals that at $K = 2$.

Example 9.3 (a repeated-root field case)**.** Take $K = \mathbb{F}_4$, $k = 1$, $\lambda = 1$, $P = 2$, $n_0 = 5$, $n = 10$. This case is chosen because it is genuinely repeated-root ($P = 2$) while still small, and because it contains both orbit types. The factors of $x^5 - 1$ over $\mathbb{F}_4$ have degrees $1, 2, 2$; the degree-one factor is fixed by τ, and the two degree-two factors form one orbit of length 2. Thus there are three exponent positions and $3^3 = 27$ assignments. (Dimensions in the display are over K itself; the orbit weights are therefore 1 for the length-one orbit and 2 for the length-two orbit.)

The point of the example is that the distribution below was computed in two independent ways: from the exponent formulas of Theorems 5.2 and 6.3, and directly from codes, by forming, for each assignment a, the generator g_a, a basis of shifts, and the rank of the code-first Gram matrix $\big(\sum_j B_{t,j}\sigma(B_{r,j})\big)$. The two computations agree on the joint $(\dim_K C, \dim_K \mathrm{Hull}_1(C))$ distribution

$$\{(0,0):1,(1,1):1,(2,0):1,(2,2):2,(3,3):2,(4,2):2,(4,4):3,(5,5):3,(6,2):2,$$
$$(6,4):3,(7,3):2,(8,0):1,(8,2):2,(9,1):1,(10,0):1\},$$

whose entries sum to 27, as they must. The moment formulas can be understood orbit by orbit: the length-one orbit is a self-loop and contributes $\nu_2 = 1/3$, whereas the length-two orbit has weight 2 and two edges, hence contributes $2 \cdot 2\mu_2 = 20/9$. This gives $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{Hull}] = 23/9 = \nu_2 + 2 \cdot 2\mu_2 = \frac{1}{3} + \frac{20}{9}$ — the separate ν_P term is not a cosmetic distinction here, since using μ_2 for the length-one orbit as well would give the wrong mean. The variance is $\mathrm{Var}(\mathrm{Hull}) = 194/81$ from Theorem 8.4. The counting corollaries are equally visible: there are two orbits, so the LCD count is $4 = 2^2$ (Corollary 7.3), and the self-orthogonal and dual-containing counts agree at 12, in line with Corollary 7.5 and its refinement in Corollary 7.6.

Example 9.4 (orbit of length 6)**.** Take $K = \mathbb{F}_8$, $k = 1$, $\lambda = 1$, $P = 2$, $n_0 = 7$, $n = 14$. The seven linear factors of $x^7 - 1$ form τ-orbits of lengths 1 and 6, so there are $3^7 = 2187$

assignments. Whereas Example 9.3 tests mixed orbit lengths, this example is included for the length-six orbit. The Gram-rank computation was compared with the exponent formula assignment by assignment, not only through the aggregated distribution; it gives $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{Hull}] = 11/3$ and $\mathrm{Var}(\mathrm{Hull}) = 10/9 = V_1(2) + V_6(2) = \frac{2}{9} + \frac{8}{9}$, with LCD count 4 and self-orthogonal = dual-containing count 258. The mean decomposition is again instructive: the length-one orbit contributes $\nu_2 = 1/3$, and the length-six orbit, of weight 1 with six edges, contributes $6\mu_2 = 10/3$.

For the record, the full joint distribution of $(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C, \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C))$ is $(0,0)\colon 1,\ (1,1)\colon 7,\ (2,0)\colon 1,\ (2,2)\colon 27,\ (3,1)\colon 6,\ (3,2)\colon 12,\ (3,3)\colon 59,\ (4,2)\colon 33,\ (4,3)\colon 48,\ (4,4)\colon 80,\ (5,2)\colon 24,\ (5,3)\colon 86,\ (5,4)\colon 96,\ (5,5)\colon 60,\ (6,2)\colon 24,\ (6,3)\colon 84,\ (6,4)\colon 144,\ (6,5)\colon 84,\ (6,6)\colon 21,\ (7,2)\colon 24,\ (7,3)\colon 84,\ (7,4)\colon 156,\ (7,5)\colon 102,\ (7,6)\colon 24,\ (7,7)\colon 3,\ (8,2)\colon 24,\ (8,3)\colon 84,\ (8,4)\colon 144,\ (8,5)\colon 84,\ (8,6)\colon 21,\ (9,2)\colon 24,\ (9,3)\colon 86,\ (9,4)\colon 96,\ (9,5)\colon 60,\ (10,2)\colon 33,\ (10,3)\colon 48,\ (10,4)\colon 80,\ (11,1)\colon 6,\ (11,2)\colon 12,\ (11,3)\colon 59,\ (12,0)\colon 1,\ (12,2)\colon 27,\ (13,1)\colon 7,\ (14,0)\colon 1.$

The exponent formula is thus checked against the hull dimensions of actual codes on an orbit of length 6. One point must be stated correctly: a dimension check of this kind cannot certify the predecessor orientation, because the hull dimension does not depend on the orientation convention at all — for all a, b, $\min(P-a, b) - \min(P-b, a) = b - a$, which telescopes to 0 around any orbit, so the predecessor and successor readings give the same hull dimension for every assignment (cf. the remark after Theorem 6.3). The orientation is instead visible in the hull generator: here, the exponent of f_i in $h^{\#}$ equals the predecessor value $P - \alpha_{i-1}$ for every one of the 2187 assignments, while the successor value $P - \alpha_{i+1}$ agrees only for 27 of them (checked in `code/validate_audit_fixes.py`). The predecessor orientation is fixed by the code-first pairing (Theorem 4.3).

Example 9.5 (two components)**.** The final example tests the assembly step (Proposition 6.2 and Theorem 6.3), rather than a single orbit. Let $A = \mathbb{F}_2 \times \mathbb{F}_4$ ($q = 2$, $k = 0$, $\lambda = (1,1)$, $P = 2$, $n_0 = 7$). The orbit data (L_O, w_O) are $(1,1), (2,3)$ on the first component and $(1,2), (2,6)$ on the second: four orbits and $1 + 2 + 1 + 2 = 6$ exponent positions in total, hence $3^6 = 729$ labeled assignments. Because assignments on distinct orbits are independent, the global joint distribution is the convolution (equivalently, the coefficientwise product) of the four per-orbit distributions of Theorem 6.1; the same distribution is obtained by computing the two components separately and adding their dimensions. This agreement is the concrete content of the product formula in Theorem 6.3.

The summary numbers illustrate how the global formulas are assembled. There are four orbits, so the LCD count is $2^4 = 16$ (Corollary 7.3). The self-orthogonal and dual-containing counts are 144 each, as Corollary 7.5 predicts. The mean splits according to orbit length: the two length-one orbits contribute $(1 + 2)\nu_2 = 1$, while the two length-two orbits contribute $(3 \cdot 2 + 6 \cdot 2)\mu_2 = 10$, giving $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{Hull}] = 11$ (Theorem 8.2). Likewise the variance is the weight-squared sum $\mathrm{Var}(\mathrm{Hull}) = 230/9$ of Theorem 8.4, namely $1^2V_1(2)+3^2V_2(2)+2^2V_1(2)+6^2V_2(2) = 230/9$. Thus Example 9.5 verifies, in one place, the independence of orbit blocks, the $L = 1$ versus $L \geq 2$ mean constants, and the the w_O^2 weighting in the variance.

Example 9.6 (a twist of order four)**.** All field-level examples so far have $\lambda = 1$. Take instead $K = \mathbb{F}_9 = \mathbb{F}_3(\iota)$ with $\iota^2 = -1$, $k = 1$, $\lambda = \iota$ of order 4 (compatible, since $\lambda^{1+3} = \lambda^4 = 1$), $P = 3$, $n_0 = 4$, $n = 12$. Here $\mu = -\iota$, and $x^4 - \mu = x^4 + \iota$ factors over $\mathbb{F}_9$ as two irreducible quadratics forming a single τ-orbit of length 2; hence there are $(3 + 1)^2 = 16$ assignments. The joint distribution of $(\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} C, \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathrm{Hull}_k(C))$ is $\{(0,0) : 1, (2,2) : 2, (4,4) : 3, (6,6) : 4, (8,4) : 3, (10,2) : 2, (12,0) : 1\}$; hence $\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{Hull}] = 7/2$ and $\mathrm{Var}(\mathrm{Hull}) = 15/4$, the LCD count is $2 = 2^1$ (one orbit), and the self-orthogonal and dual-containing counts are 10 each. Every value was recomputed by Gram-rank brute force over the explicitly constructed codes (`code/validate_audit_fixes.py`), so the constacyclic theory is exercised here beyond the cyclic case $\lambda = 1$ and the negacyclic case $\lambda = -1$.

Computational verification. All formulas above were checked by exact (integer and rational) computation; the scripts and their saved outputs accompany the paper in the directory `code/`. (i) *Orbit level* (`code/validate_p1_14.py`): direct enumeration of exponent tuples against the transfer traces of Theorem 6.1, on the grid of 52 pairs (P, L) with $P \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9\}$, $1 \le L \le 8$ and $(P+1)^L \le 10^5$; the moment closed forms were also rederived symbolically from their defining sums. (ii) *Field level*: Gram-rank brute force over explicitly constructed codes for $\mathbb{F}_4$ with $n_0 = 3$ (27 assignments) and $n_0 = 5$ (27), $\mathbb{F}_9$ with $k = 1$, $\lambda = 1$ (256) and $\lambda = -1$ (256), $\mathbb{F}_3$ with $\lambda = -1$ (16), and $\mathbb{F}_8$ with $n_0 = 7$ (2187) — 2769 field-level assignments in total — together with the two-component assembly of Example 9.5 (729 assignments), checked by convolution of the component distributions. (iii) The twist of order four in Example 9.6 (16 assignments) and further field-level cases with $P \in \{4, 8, 9\}$ ($\mathbb{F}_2$ with $P = 4$ (25) and $P = 8$ (81); $\mathbb{F}_3$ with $P = 9$ (100)) are checked in `code/validate_audit_fixes.py`, which also verifies the hull-generator orientation statement of Example 9.4. These computations are supporting evidence for the tested cases; the proofs of Sections 3–8 are independent of them.

10 Limitations and scope

Scope. All enumerations count labeled exponent assignments over a fixed labeled decomposition $A \cong \prod_s K_s$; they are not counts of equivalence or isometry classes of codes, and no such interpretation should be attached to $\mathcal{E}(u, z)$. Only compatible twists are treated: for incompatible λ_s, Theorem 4.3 persists in the two-modulus form $x^n - \lambda_s^{-p^{d_s-k}}$, but the hull formula and everything following it are not asserted. The alphabet is reduced (square-free) by the standing hypothesis $A \cong \prod_s K_s$; non-reduced alphabets, such as chain rings, are outside the scope, as are distances, which the enumerator does not address. The means and variances of Section 8 refer to the uniform distribution on labeled assignments; orbit contributions are independent in this model, edges within an orbit are not (Lemma 8.3), and the $L = 1$, $L = 2$, $L \ge 3$ regimes are genuinely distinct. Finally, the predecessor index α_{i-1} in Theorems 4.3–6.3 is tied to the code-first pairing of Section 2: reversing the convention replaces ρ by σ and α_{i-1} by α_{i+1}. By the telescoping identity $\min(P-a, b) - \min(P-b, a) = b-a$, every hull dimension — and hence every statistic of Sections 7 and 8 — is unchanged assignment by assignment; the convention is visible only in the identification of the hull generator (Theorem 5.2), not in any dimension.

Open problems. Natural directions include the incompatible-twist regime, where the dual exists in a two-modulus form but the hull intersection must be reconsidered; counting up to monomial equivalence rather than by labeled assignments; the extension from constacyclic (index-one) to multi-twisted codes; and distance distributions, which would require machinery beyond the enumerator.

11 Conclusion

For repeated-root constacyclic codes over a finite product of finite fields with compatible twists, the joint distribution of code dimension and Galois hull dimension over all labeled exponent assignments is given by a product of transfer-matrix traces indexed by the orbits of the reciprocal involution. The enumerator yields the total count, the code-dimension distribution, the LCD count $2^{\#\text{orbits}}$, the self-orthogonal and dual-containing counts, and exact mean and variance formulas in which length-one orbits enter through the separate constant ν_P. At $P = 1$ the theory reduces to the binary simple-root enumerator. Natural directions for further work include the incompatible-twist regime, where the dual already exists in a two-modulus form but the hull intersection must be reconsidered; counting up to monomial equivalence rather than by labeled assignments; and distance questions, which the enumerator alone does not address.

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